IELTS ACADEMIC · RESTRICTED STAFF MATERIAL

IELTS Academic Set 23

PRIVATE STAFF answer key and Listening transcript

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Answer keys and Listening transcripts are restricted to staff.

Listening

Question	Answer	Accepted variants
1	The Tempest	
2	boatswain	
3	oilskin coat	
4	86	86 cm, 86 centimetres, 86 centimeters
5	18 September	18th September, September 18, September 18th, 18/9, 18.09
6	4:30	4.30, 4 30, 16:30, 16.30, 16 30
7	damage check	
8	dry	
9	hat box	
10	wardrobe office	
11	A	
12	D	
13	C	
14	F	
15	H	
16	B	
17	B	
18	A	

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Question	Answer	Accepted variants
19	E	
20	D	
21	B	
22	A	
23	C	
24	B	
25	C	
26	B	
27	A	
28	C	
29	A	
30	B	
31	faces	face
32	dust	
33	manganese	
34	bacteria	
35	millimetre	millimeter
36	sandstone	
37	magnetic analysis	magnetic
38	demagnetization experiment	demagnetisation experiment
39	magnetite	
40	Mars	

Listening transcript

Part 1 - everyday social dialogue

RHYS	Good afternoon, Cwm Lane Costume Store. Rhys Llewellyn speaking. How can I help?
CARYS	Hello, Rhys. I'm Carys Morgan from the Penylan Players. We are staging a play next month, and I need to hire one costume for myself. I filled in most of the online enquiry, but the director changed my part this morning.
RHYS	No problem. I can update the hire form while we talk. The company sent an enquiry headed The Duchess, although I also saw a note about The Tempest. Which production is this costume actually for?

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CARYS	The Duchess was cancelled. Please enter The Tempest; that is the production opening in October.
RHYS	Thanks. Your first message said you were playing the ship’s captain. Has that changed as well? We have several naval coats, but the cut depends on whether the character is an officer or a working sailor.
CARYS	Yes. Another actor is the captain now. I’m the boatswain, the sailor who directs the deck crew, so the clothes should look practical rather than grand.
RHYS	That helps. For that period I could offer heavy trousers, a short wool jacket and an oilskin coat. The jacket photographs well, but it is quite warm under stage lights. Which single outer garment does your designer want us to reserve?
CARYS	The oilskin coat, please. The director wants its wet-weather look for the opening scene. We will supply the trousers ourselves.
RHYS	Fine. I have your height from the form, but not your waist. Please give the body measurement, not the size printed inside your everyday jeans, because costume labels vary enormously.
CARYS	I wrote eighty-four centimetres last year. I measured again today and it is eighty-six, so record 86 centimetres.
RHYS	Now the fitting. I initially offered Tuesday the seventeenth of September, but our alterations volunteer will be at another theatre that day. We have Wednesday the eighteenth or Friday the twentieth instead.
CARYS	Wednesday is better because rehearsal begins later. Let’s make the fitting 18 September.
RHYS	On Wednesday I can see you at four o’clock or half past four. The earlier slot gives you more time, though the fitting itself normally takes only twenty minutes.
CARYS	I teach until four, so I could not cross town in time. Please book 4:30.
RHYS	Done. Let me explain the collection and return conditions. You pay a deposit when you collect the outfit. Returning it by the agreed Monday is important, but the date alone does not release the money.
CARYS	So the deposit stays with you until someone has looked at the costume?
RHYS	Exactly. We release it after a damage check. Ordinary stage dust is expected, but tears, missing fasteners or permanent marks have to be recorded first.
CARYS	The designer may also borrow your sea boots. Should we polish them before bringing them back?
RHYS	No polish, please, because it can change the finish. Wipe away loose dirt and keep the boots dry. If they come back wet inside, the leather can distort while they are stored.
CARYS	Understood. There is a broad sailor’s hat in the photograph. Can that travel with the coat on a hanger?
RHYS	The coat can hang in its cover, but the hat must not be crushed. Carry that piece in the hat box we provide, even on the short journey from the store to the theatre.
CARYS	And if our final performance runs late, shall I message you personally before the Monday return?

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RHYS	I may be away with another production. Contact the wardrobe office instead. That team can extend the booking in the system and tell you whether another group is waiting for the same pieces.
CARYS	Great. I have the updated title, my new role, the measurements and all the care instructions. I'll bring the deposit card to the fitting.
RHYS	Perfect. I'll email the revised booking this afternoon. If the director adds any accessories, reply before your appointment so we can have them ready.

Part 2 - everyday social monologue

HINE	Kia ora, everyone. I'm Hine Carter, coordinator of the Te Awa Community Orchard open day. Before the gates open, I'll explain the one-way visitor route and then match four activities with their working areas. The orchard is productive ground, not a formal park, so please follow the arrows and keep clear of taped rows.
HINE	Look at the plan with north at the top. Visitors enter through the south gate. A boot-cleaning point is already printed just inside it; everyone brushes soil from footwear there before following the gravel path. Do not turn directly towards the packing shed on the east, because that section is the return leg.
HINE	After the brushes, the route bends left. The first space you reach is beside the low fence in the south-west corner. That is where volunteers give the safety welcome and hand out route cards, so this is the welcome gazebo. The small square farther north is a water tank, not a public shelter.
HINE	From the gazebo, continue north between the young apple rows until you reach the old pear tree at the central fork. The canvas structure immediately east of that tree is where specialists demonstrate joining new varieties onto rootstock, so that is the grafting tent. The larger roof on the far east belongs to the packing shed.
HINE	Families then take the western loop. Just beyond the compost bays, the path curls through a small group of numbered trees with lift-up signs and scent boxes. That is the children's discovery trail. The strip farther north beside the shelterbelt is closed today because pruning work is unfinished.
HINE	The arrows next cross the top of the site. Do not enter the beehive enclosure marked by a warning triangle. The flower beds immediately south of the hives are the safe viewing area for insects; this is the pollinator garden. Staff will keep the gate between the flowers and the hives locked.
HINE	At the north-east bend you will see the harvest barn. The long table for weighing, sorting and displaying picked fruit stands on the open apron just west of the barn. That is the harvest table. It was originally going beside the pond on the western side, but the ground there remained soft after rain, so that plan was changed.
HINE	The return path runs south along the eastern boundary. Before you reach the exit, borrowed picking poles and baskets go back beside the tool shed. That position is the tool-return point. Please do not leave equipment at the welcome gazebo, even if that is where you collected your route card.
HINE	Let me finish with the activity arrangements. A few locations have changed since the first programme was circulated, mainly because some sessions need shelter or specialist equipment, so please use the final placements I'm about to give rather than last week's notice.

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HINE	The cider press is heavy and needs washable flooring, power and a drain. Although visitors might enjoy watching from the lawn, the actual cider-pressing demonstration will take place inside the packing shed. A viewing line will keep hands away from the moving parts.
HINE	For the soil-health clinic, growers will bring small labelled samples and discuss texture, drainage and nutrient tests. Wind would scatter the loose material outdoors, so the advisers have moved this session into the orchard classroom. The compost yard is useful for demonstrations, but not for examining individual samples.
HINE	Fruit that householders cannot use may be placed on the surplus table. We considered the packing shed, but that would mix private donations with produce being prepared for sale. The surplus-fruit exchange will therefore be on the picnic terrace, where donors can label items and visitors can carry them directly to the car park.
HINE	The mulch-making workshop needs piles of chipped prunings, fallen leaves and finished compost. Those materials are already stored in the compost yard, so the session stays there. Participants will compare the ingredients but will not take material into the classroom.
HINE	Two final practical points: wash or brush soil from shoes and tools before arriving, because pests, diseases and weed seeds can travel in mud. Please also eat only in the signed picnic areas. Windfall fruit within taped research rows is being monitored and is not available for picking.
HINE	The one-way route brings everyone back to the eastern exit. If you need a shorter visit, ask a marshal at the central fork rather than walking against the arrows. Enjoy the orchard, and please leave enough time to return borrowed equipment before the gates close.

Part 3 - educational discussion

HARRIET	Thanks for coming before your next tank booking. Your first wave-energy model run produced a useful pattern, but the force readings became inconsistent halfway through. I want us to separate a problem with the model from a problem with the measuring chain.
NIA	I checked the wave-paddle programme first. The commanded heights and periods match our planning sheet, and the two wave gauges nearest the paddle show the waves were generated as requested.
OWAIN	I wondered whether the foam model slowly absorbed water. Its mass increased by four grams after the session, though that seems too small to explain the sudden jump in the force trace.
HARRIET	Agreed. A gradual mass change would normally give a gradual shift. What physical change did you notice at the sensor itself?
OWAIN	When I removed the model, the upper bracket holding the force sensor had become loose. It could rock by about two millimetres. That fits the abrupt change much better than the paddle setting or the small mass gain.
NIA	Should we print a fresh model before repeating the work? The existing one has marker lines and a few scratches from the clamps, so a new surface would look cleaner on video.
OWAIN	Printing would take most of tomorrow, and we could paint the replacement quickly, but appearance is not really the issue. I would rather know whether tightening the bracket removes the variation.
HARRIET	That is the stronger design. Keep the existing model for the short rerun, because changing only the measurement setup lets you isolate the fault. A new model would introduce another source of variation before you have tested the bracket explanation.

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NIA	For the wave conditions, our old table moves neatly from the lowest height to the highest and keeps each period together. It is easy for the technician to follow, but any warming or drift in the sensor would then be confused with wave size.
OWAIN	We could reverse the order and start high. That would reveal one kind of drift, although it would still tie time to wave height.
HARRIET	Exactly. Do not simply reverse it or group all runs by period. Use a randomised sequence, with one repeated reference condition at intervals. Then a slow change over time is less likely to imitate an effect of height or period.
NIA	I also mounted an overhead camera. From that angle we can track how far the float moves sideways, but perspective distortion makes precise displacement difficult unless we add a calibration grid.
OWAIN	Could the camera replace the second wave gauge? Its view includes the free surface near the model.
HARRIET	No. Keep both gauges for water-level data. The overhead video’s main job is to check the timing of impact events against sudden peaks in the force record. Frame accuracy is adequate for that, even if position estimates remain rough.
NIA	How much of the plan should we run before committing to the full matrix? If the model returns to the same centre mark after each test, that would at least show the mooring is stable.
OWAIN	And the peak force should stay under the design limit, but we already expect that at the modest pilot height.
HARRIET	Run three reference waves first. The pilot succeeds if the two wave gauges record a consistent phase relationship across those repeats. That checks the generated field and the acquisition timing before you interpret the force signal.
HARRIET	Now let’s divide up the preparation so everything is ready before the technician arrives. We’ll take each job in turn and flag anything that needs formal approval.
OWAIN	I loosened the sensor assembly when we packed it, so I should recalibrate the force sensor after fitting the replacement locking washer. I’ll document the zero check and the known-load check.
NIA	I will rewrite the randomisation schedule and include the reference runs. I already have the script that shuffles conditions without putting two highest-energy cases together.
OWAIN	The washer changes the assembly procedure. Do we need to amend the risk assessment ourselves?
HARRIET	You can add the mechanical detail, but I must approve the revised risk assessment as supervisor before the tank technician accepts it. Send me the marked version by noon.
NIA	While Owain works on the sensor, I can check the camera timestamps against the acquisition computer. I’ll film the same flashing clock with both systems and record any offset.
OWAIN	Then I’ll request the wave-paddle logs from the technician. They contain the actual command and feedback traces, not just the settings we copied into the planning sheet.
HARRIET	Good. Bring all five records to the pre-run meeting: calibration sheet, random order, approved risk assessment, camera offset and paddle log. If the pilot passes, you can proceed to the reduced matrix that afternoon.

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NIA	I'll also label the raw files before anyone processes them, so the repeated reference runs cannot be mistaken for duplicates.
OWAIN	And I'll photograph the tightened bracket from both sides. If it moves again, we will have a visual record of the starting position.
HARRIET	That is enough for this stage. The purpose of the rerun is diagnosis, not producing a perfect final graph. Keep changes limited, preserve the raw data and write down any departure from the plan as it happens.

Part 4 - academic monologue

LECTURER	Today we examine desert varnish: the dark brown, black or reddish film seen on exposed rocks in many arid landscapes. Despite its name, it is not a manufactured varnish and it is not the same as a thick weathering crust. It is extremely thin, often less than half a millimetre, yet it can preserve a record of processes operating over very long periods.
LECTURER	First, where is it found? The film develops on stable rock faces that meet the atmosphere. Fresh fractures usually lack it, while older exposed sides may carry a continuous sheen. Shade, slope and the stability of the underlying rock all matter, so neighbouring exposures can look different even when they are made from the same stone.
LECTURER	The bulk of the coating is not material leaking out of the host rock. Fine airborne dust settles on the surface, bringing clay minerals and small quantities of iron and manganese compounds. Local bedrock may influence the setting, but analyses often point to material transported through the atmosphere rather than extracted directly from the rock beneath.
LECTURER	Colour reflects composition. Iron oxides contribute red and brown tones, while the darkest patches are associated with unusually concentrated manganese. Silicon-rich clay minerals may make up much of the film by mass, but manganese has a disproportionate visual effect. A tiny chemical fraction can therefore dominate what an observer sees.
LECTURER	How does that concentration arise? One long-standing biological hypothesis proposes that metal-oxidising bacteria on the rock concentrate the dark element as part of their interaction with the coating. Finding biological material in a sample does not by itself prove that living cells built the entire film, but bacteria make a testable contribution to this explanation.
LECTURER	A competing family of explanations gives more weight to non-biological chemistry. Changes in acidity, evaporation and the properties of clay surfaces may trap metal compounds without requiring organisms to construct the layer. These mechanisms are not mutually exclusive: mineral deposition can create a habitat, and biological activity can then alter what has already accumulated.
LECTURER	Before considering specialised measurements, remember the scale of the object. The repository description calls the coating very thin: typically it is less than half a millimetre thick. A field photograph can make the dark material look substantial, but a sample cut through the surface shows how little material the analysis actually contains.
LECTURER	That small amount must be separated conceptually from the rock beneath it. In the comparison described by the researchers, the substrate rock was sandstone. The varnish and the sandstone gave noticeably different magnetic behaviour, so treating the coating as merely the outermost colour of an unchanged substrate would miss an important distinction.

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LECTURER	The team noted that magnetic analysis had rarely been applied to desert varnish, even though iron-bearing minerals can respond strongly to such methods. Chemical composition tells us which elements are present; the magnetic approach asks which mineral phases may carry the signal. The two forms of evidence are related but not interchangeable.
LECTURER	Their discussion refers to a demagnetization experiment in which the response of a varnish sample was compared with that of the rock beneath it. The result showed noticeable differences in magnetic properties. The experiment did not by itself settle how the coating formed; it narrowed the interpretation of the magnetic material within it.
LECTURER	From those results, the earlier investigators proposed two candidates for the main magnetic component. The first was magnetite, an iron oxide familiar in magnetic studies. The other was maghemite, a related iron oxide presented as the alternative. Distinguishing what was said about each mineral matters because the evidence did not establish that the two labels were interchangeable.
LECTURER	The possibility of a biological contribution attracts attention beyond terrestrial geology. Varnish-like coatings are interesting in discussions of Mars because a mineral film could, in principle, preserve chemical or textural clues about past environments. This does not mean that a dark coating is automatically a biosignature; it means the material deserves careful, contamination-aware analysis.
LECTURER	We can now compare the hypotheses more fairly. A purely biological story must explain why mineral patterns track exposure and airborne supply. A purely inorganic story must explain the striking enrichment of certain elements and the recurring association with microbial traces. The strongest research designs test predictions from both accounts on the same samples.
LECTURER	Sampling itself needs care. The film is thin, so a tool can easily include the underlying rock and dilute the signal. Researchers document orientation, take adjacent controls and use methods that preserve spatial relationships. A bulk chemical value without that context may conceal the difference between a surface layer and its substrate.
LECTURER	The broader lesson is methodological. Desert varnish looks simple from a distance, but its origin involves transported particles, intermittent water, surface chemistry, possible organisms and long exposure. No single colour, element or microbe settles the debate. Progress comes from connecting measurements to explicit competing explanations while preserving the history of the sampled surface.

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Reading

Question	Answer	Accepted variants
1	lamp	
2	concentric prisms	prisms
3	flash panel	panel
4	roller carriage	carriage
5	clockwork unit	clockwork
6	drive weight	weight
7	F	
8	B	
9	G	
10	A	
11	E	
12	B	
13	F	
14	A	
15	C	
16	B	
17	D	
18	A	
19	D	
20	C	
21	estimating time	
22	21 signals	twenty-one signals
23	auditory attention	
24	negative valence	
25	trait attention	
26	repeated observations	
27	ii	
28	iv	

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Question	Answer	Accepted variants
29	vii	
30	i	
31	v	
32	iii	
33	vi	
34	NO	
35	YES	
36	NOT GIVEN	
37	YES	
38	NOT GIVEN	
39	YES	
40	YES	

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